



SHAPING THE PATH AHEAD: UNVEILING THE BOARD'S VISION FOR THE FUTURE



Navigating Today and Shaping Tomorrow: Board Priorities

How technology can help you overcome the challenges ahead

Organizations around the world are bracing for economic uncertainty in 2023 as last year's volatile climate continues to dampen global markets.

World Bank economists predict that the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) [region will grow by 3.5% this year](#), buoyed by high oil prices. However, despite this moderate growth, the region is not immune to shocks. Rising geopolitical tension, supply chain disruption, and widespread inflation mean organizations must be ready for anything.

Against this turbulent backdrop, boards need concrete strategies to protect their organizations from global disruptors. Technology has a pivotal role to play in these efforts - 89% of boards say digital is an implicit part of their growth strategies and 60% have achieved their digital transformation goals, [according to the Gartner 2023 Board of Directors Survey](#).

From AI to data analytics, evolving technology can be leveraged throughout an organization to provide efficiency gains, improve security, and do more with less. All of which significantly enhance corporate governance.

To realize these benefits, however, organizations need the right digital framework, managed by the right digital partners. All too often, companies rely on an outdated infrastructure that hinders, rather than facilitates, organizational growth and governance. In guiding digital transformation efforts, it is vital that boards set an example - embracing innovation and selecting the latest tech tools that best serve their needs.

Regardless of where they are in their digital journey, boards can ensure they are on the right track by regularly evaluating their software stack with questions such as :

- Are we working with technology partners who understand and support our operational objectives?
- Do we rely on legacy systems instead of harnessing the latest technologies?
- Are we working in data silos and, if so, how can we upgrade our digital toolkit to improve communication and collaboration?
- What improvements can the board make to its own board management software?

In this guide, we will examine how boards can shape their organization's digital transformation to align with their objectives and mitigate uncertainty in 2023.

The global vision

According to Gartner, boards will be heavily focused on three key areas in 2023 as they strive for growth amid challenging times:

1. Digitization to keep up with the post-digital world
2. Initiatives in sustainability and diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI)
3. Increasing risk appetite

89%

agree we are in a post-digital world, and digitization is a key component of growth strategy

80%

anticipate an increase in investments in sustainability initiatives in the next 2 years

75%

anticipate an increase in DEI initiatives in the next 2 years

64%

are looking to increase risk appetite

Digital acceleration

As we move into a post-digital world, further digitization of organizational processes is key for a robust growth strategy. Everyone, from directors to entry-level staff, knows that technology exists to help automate simple tasks and streamline processes, and the board can assist with this by ensuring that regular reviews of the organization's digital infrastructure are set up.

The pain points of most corporations with technology are legacy solutions and data silos. In many cases, teams become used to working with a particular software solution and this comfort prevents management from finding better, newer solutions.

Sustainability and DEI

Diversification in the MENA region will be influenced by a growing movement towards sustainability, according to the World Economic Forum which points to rising investments in non-oil sectors, such as solar and other green energies.

Globally, boards are anticipating more focus on both sustainability and DEI interests in 2023, driven by market demand. According to Gartner, over 80% of boards report that stakeholders consider sustainability and DEI when evaluating and interacting with their organizations.

Risk appetite and growth strategies

As research from Gartner shows, boards are now willing to take on elevated risk as a necessary cost to grow businesses. In the midst of the post-pandemic rebound, the Gulf region economy is diversifying, giving organizations plenty of opportunities to move into new markets and form lucrative trading partnerships. Capitalizing on this expansion will require boards to mindfully balance risk and opportunity, providing room for both in their strategies for 2023 and beyond.



Using technology to optimise your board operations

Boards take on many roles in the leadership of an organization, from strategists to investors. In all their activities they are guided by governance principles that require a high standard of security and efficiency. Board members need to be able to communicate quickly and effectively, safeguard data privacy and protection, operate transparently, and stay informed of all organizational needs.



This is difficult to fulfill, but with the right technology boards can transform these tasks and see huge improvements in:

- Performance
- Collaboration
- Security
- Transparency
- Digital adoption
- Efficiency

From cloud-based storage and digital task management to online portals that allow board members to tune into the office remotely, there are plenty of tech tools boards can leverage to improve the way they work.

How to choose a technology partner

When selecting a technology partner, boards must consider not just how easy it is to implement and use their new software, but also whether it meets their security standards and fully supports the organization's business objectives. Any new software must also adhere to, and support, organizational governance practices, prioritizing transparency and security for shareholders and other relevant parties.

The ideal technology partner is one who provides expertise as well as software. With round-the-clock support, boards and their organizations can enjoy complete peace of mind that their digital toolkit is operating as it should.



Questions to ask prospective technology vendors:

How does your board management software streamline board activities?

Board management solutions need to help boards work smarter, providing visibility, security, and accessibility across all activities. Ideally, software suites should include digitalization of key processes, entity management, evaluations, risk monitoring, data analytics, and KPI benchmarking.

Can data flow between all corporate governance units without running into roadblocks or accumulating into data silos?

Seamless and secure data sharing is a must for efficient boards, allowing them to better engage with board members, shareholders, and their organization as a whole.

Do you have ISO certification and are you GDPR compliant?

In an era of escalating cyber-attacks, security has never been more important. Boards need to be using the latest technology to mitigate the latest threats. Look for partners that can provide digital solutions that meet the most up-to-date security protocols and regulations.

An ISO certification shows that your technology partner adheres to the highest international security standards, so you can be certain that your data is as protected as possible whether you're operating from your headquarters in Qatar or doing business with a subsidiary in France. The European Union has also adopted the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), known around the world as a benchmark in privacy best practices.

Can your solution be easily implemented and integrated into our existing infrastructure?

One thing boards don't have is time to waste. Digital solutions have to be easy to master and quickly integrated so that the tools can be up and running with minimal disruption to business. Your technology partner should offer support throughout the entire process, from training and onboarding to ongoing operation and troubleshooting.





Conclusion

As the Gulf gears up for growth in 2023, digitization must be a key part of any expansion efforts. Organizations that fail to prioritize technological transformation risk being left behind.

With corporate governance gaining new momentum as the Middle East embraces international investment opportunities, this is the obvious starting point for boards looking to modernize.

The DiliTrust Board Portal

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Marie-Therese Auger
Head Of Corporate Affairs &
Company Secretary



“Dilitrust governance can generate a broad easily configurable reporting system which is accessible to indefinite number of users while setting the level of confidentiality. The tool provides a coherent and shared source of information and where the board members feel comfortable using”

Nalini Nair
Assistant Manager-Legal



The DiliTrust Board Portal is just one module of **our full-service Governance Suite** which also includes modules for entity management, contracts and litigation management, and document archiving.

The DiliTrust Governance Suite:

- Meets the highest standards of information security with ISO 27001 certification and GDPR compliance.
- Is maintained by data centers worldwide
- Includes 24/7 support, available in Arabic, English, and French
- Streamlines all legal activities in a single, easy-to-use platform

DiliTrust Governance is your ideal partner to navigate growth, providing secure and scalable solutions for robust corporate governance, board management, security, and legal operations. Our five-module platform offers everything organizations need to move forward into the year ahead. [Talk to our team today to schedule a demonstration or find out more.](#)

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